



▲ Pagans' Gate

The triumphal arch (the Heidentor) at Carnuntum, in modern-day Austria, signified Roman rule to Guido von List. In 1875, he honored an old Roman defeat at the site by burying eight wine bottles in the shape of a swastika under the arch. List's adoption of the swastika as an Aryan symbol paved the way for its later use by the Nazis.

MAN IS ONE WITH GOD

the German occult revival

In the 19th century, nationalist sentiment spread across much of Europe. Its primary results were political: Germany was unified into a formalized empire in 1871, and Italy became one kingdom around 1870. As a secondary outcome, in the German-speaking world, nationalism sparked a renewed interest in a supposedly lost aspect of German culture—mythic, pre-Christian paganism, a tradition that celebrated the expression of what its admirers considered to be true German virtues. At

the same time, a revival of occult practices, which emphasized ancient spiritual and magical learning, found adherents in Germanic countries, as well as in other parts of Europe.

Paganism and mysticism

The central figure in the promotion of Germanic pagan heritage was an Austrian poet and occultist, Guido von List. A champion of Norse mythology, List became a devotee of Wotan (or Odin), the god of war